

LEON GAWENDA

Ph.D. Candidate and Research Associate
Bielefeld University (Faculty of Sociology)

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My current PhD research investigates territorial politics and their history. I study spatial patterns of political participation and geographical representation. I rely on electoral data, survey data, and parliamentary speech data using quantitative methods.

EDUCATION

Bielefeld University

Sep 2024 – present

- Ph.D. candidate in Sociology, supervisor: Prof. Dr. Martin Kroh
- Research associate at the Leibniz Science Campus, SOEP RegioHub

Tübingen University

2021 – 2024

- M.A. Public Policy & Social Change
- stay abroad at Sciences Po, Aix-en-Provence (FR)
- Thesis: Environmental issue salience and policy support

Passau University

2017 – 2021

- B.A. Governance & Public Policy

CURRENT PROJECTS

Explaining continuity in Germany's electoral geography across 130 years

Working paper

Electoral and social-structural data of Imperial Germany

Data set

Who speaks for the left-behind? Framing of spatial inequalities in parliamentary speeches

Working paper with Chen Zeng and Konstantin Wandel

Environmental issue salience and policy support

Working paper

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

AK Wahlen Jahrestagung, Free University Berlin

Sep 2025

EPOP Annual Conference 2025, Exeter University

Sep 2025

Paper presentation

Workshop on Political Behaviour in Central and Eastern Europe, EUI Florence

Jun 2025

Paper presentation

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tübingen University

- Tutorial for "Methods of policy evaluation: panel analysis and quasi-experiments" (Graduate)
- Tutorial for "Introduction to quantitative analysis" (Undergraduate)

SKILLS

Statistical analysis R, Stata

Languages German, English (fluent), Spanish (advanced), French (basic)